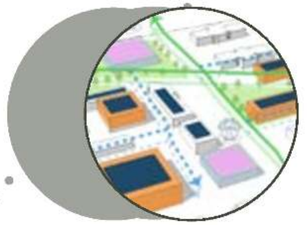


the connection

Stephanie Schmitt, Leighton Warner,
JR Musolf, Teague Roark



Contents



the vision

what is the future of 1636 N College?



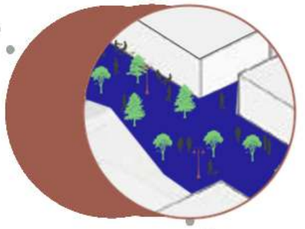
the plan

how will planning achieve project goals?



the design

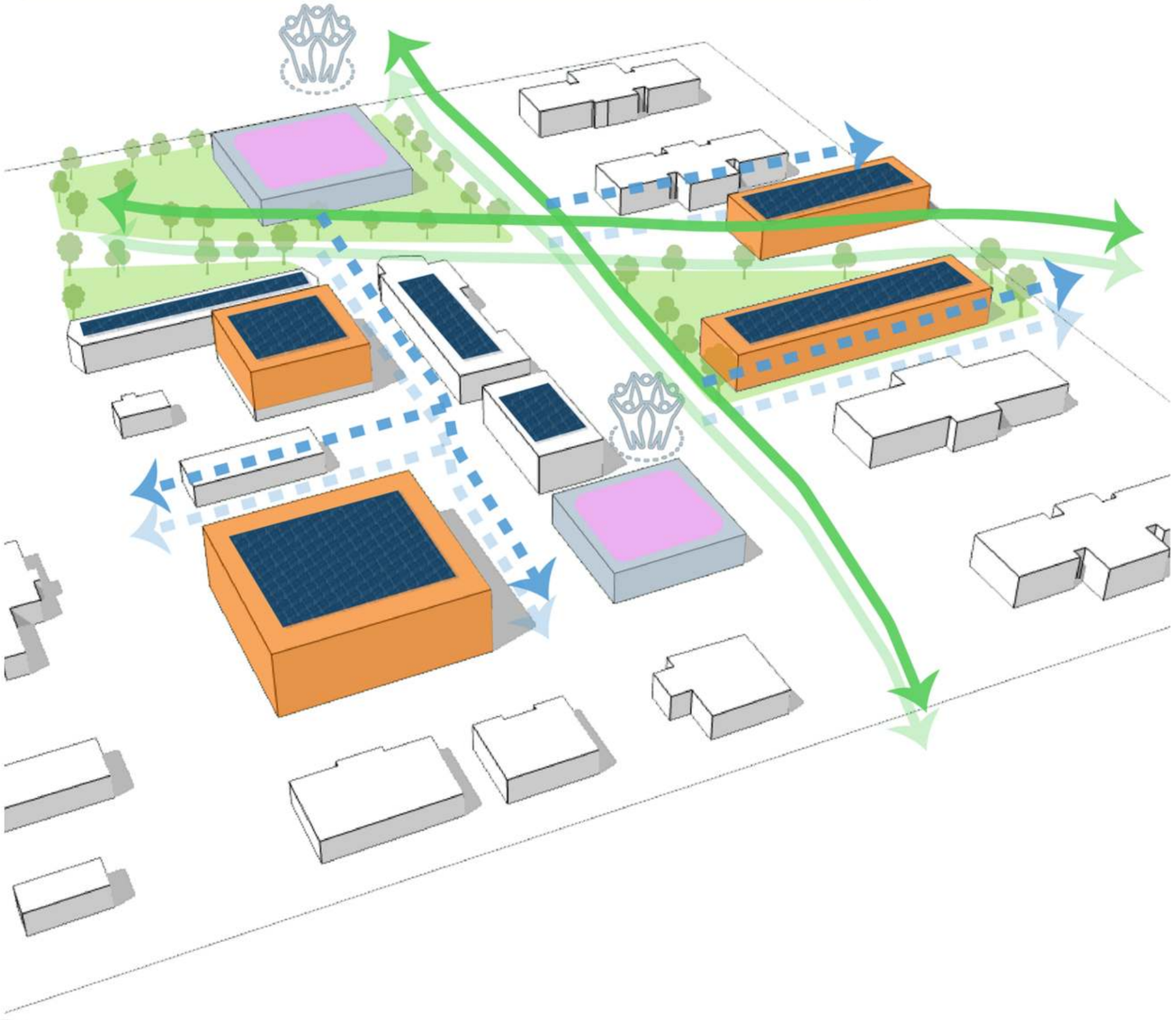
how will design fulfill project goals?



the people

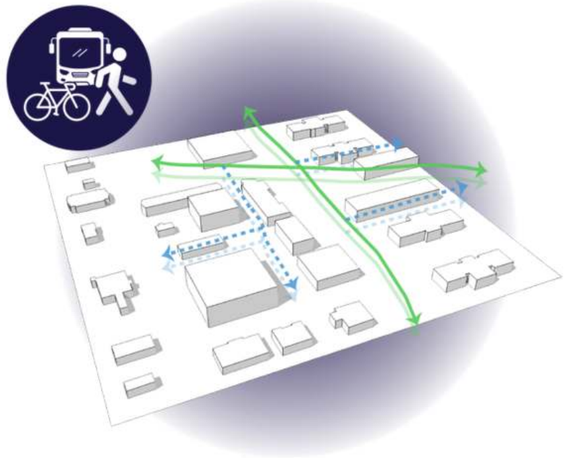
who will be impacted and how will they contribute?

Vision



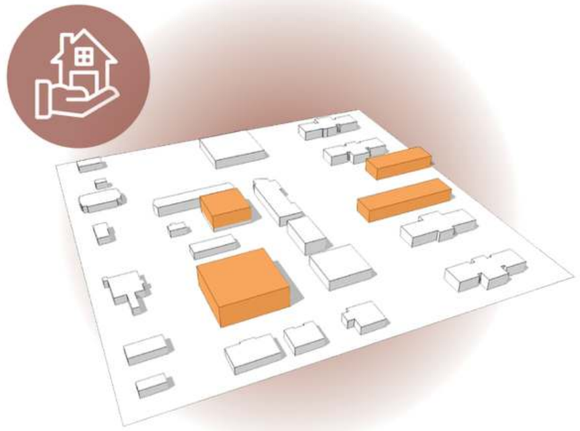
The Connection is a sustainable and equitable hub of culture, art, and recreation. A human scale and local connection allow this uptown location to have a distinct “downtown” feel catered to the diverse communities in the North College Neighborhoods.

Sustainable Design



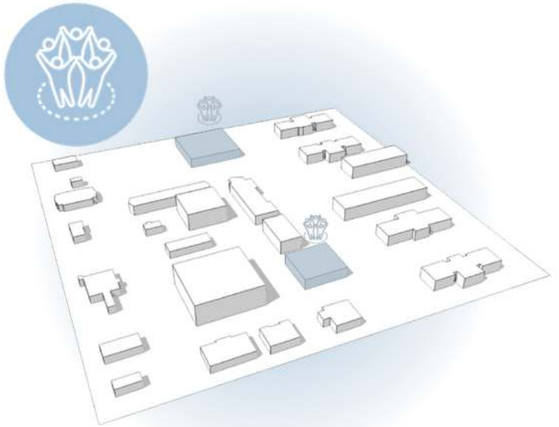
Freedom of Mobility

multi-modal mobility hub and enhanced bike and pedestrian infrastructure



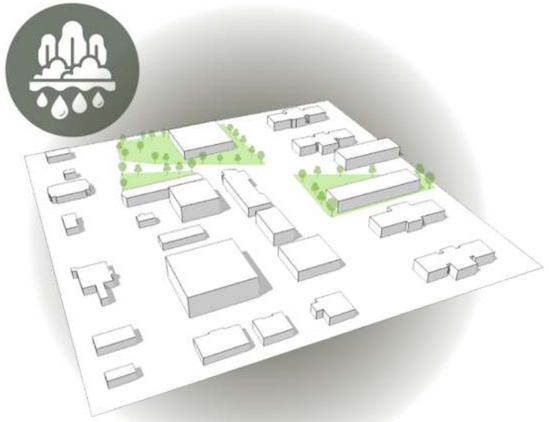
Affordable Housing

affordable housing units integrated into walkable mixed use blocks



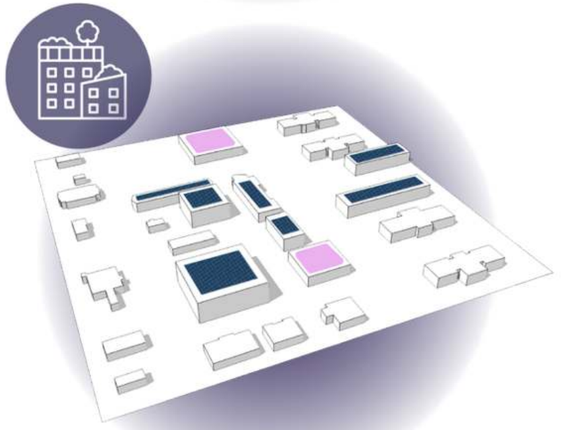
Community Empowerment

creation of shared public spaces, community hubs, and cultural centers



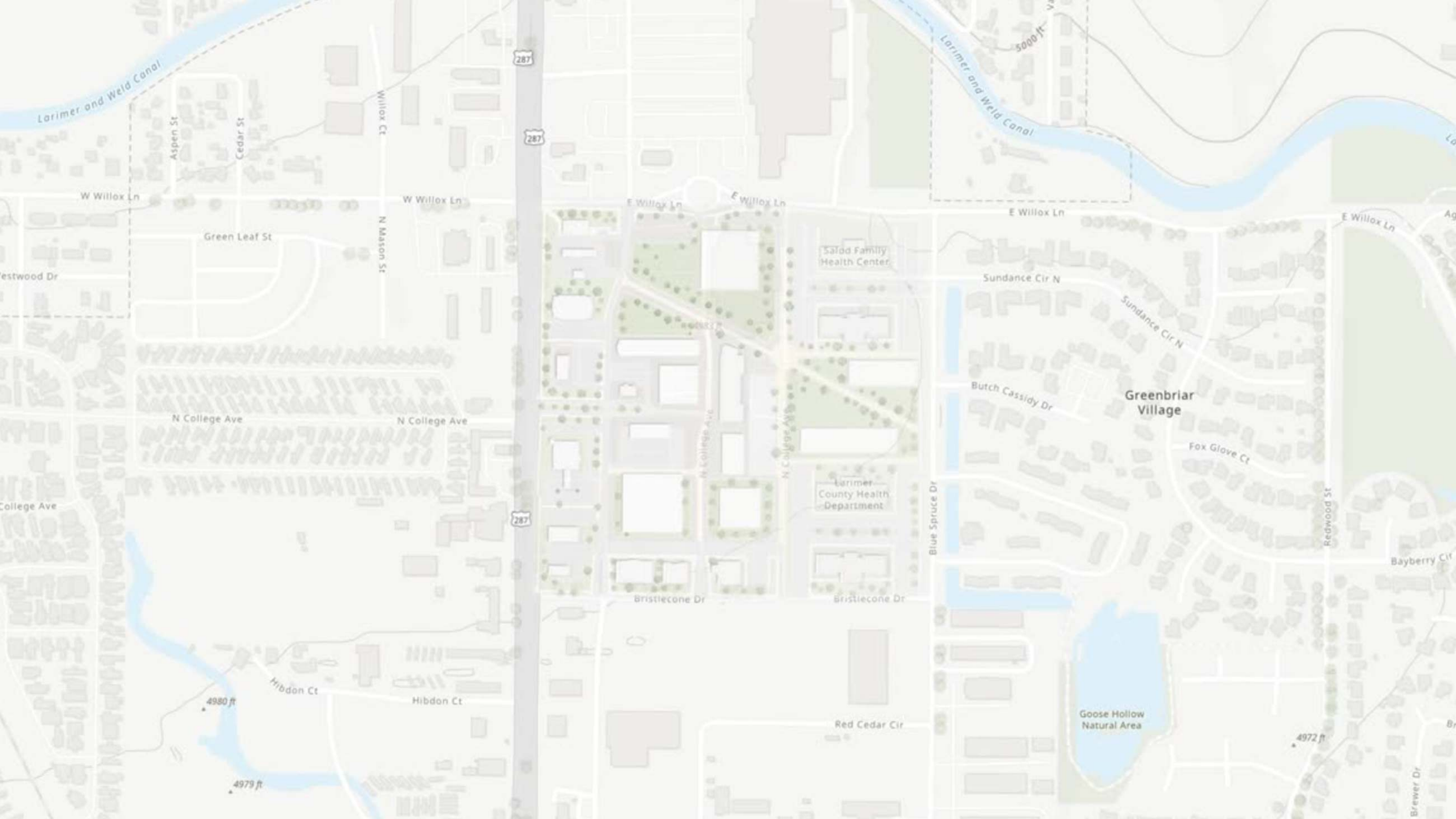
Water-Sensitive Green Spaces

adaptive reuse of vacant land into water conserving, natively landscaped green spaces



Roof Optimization

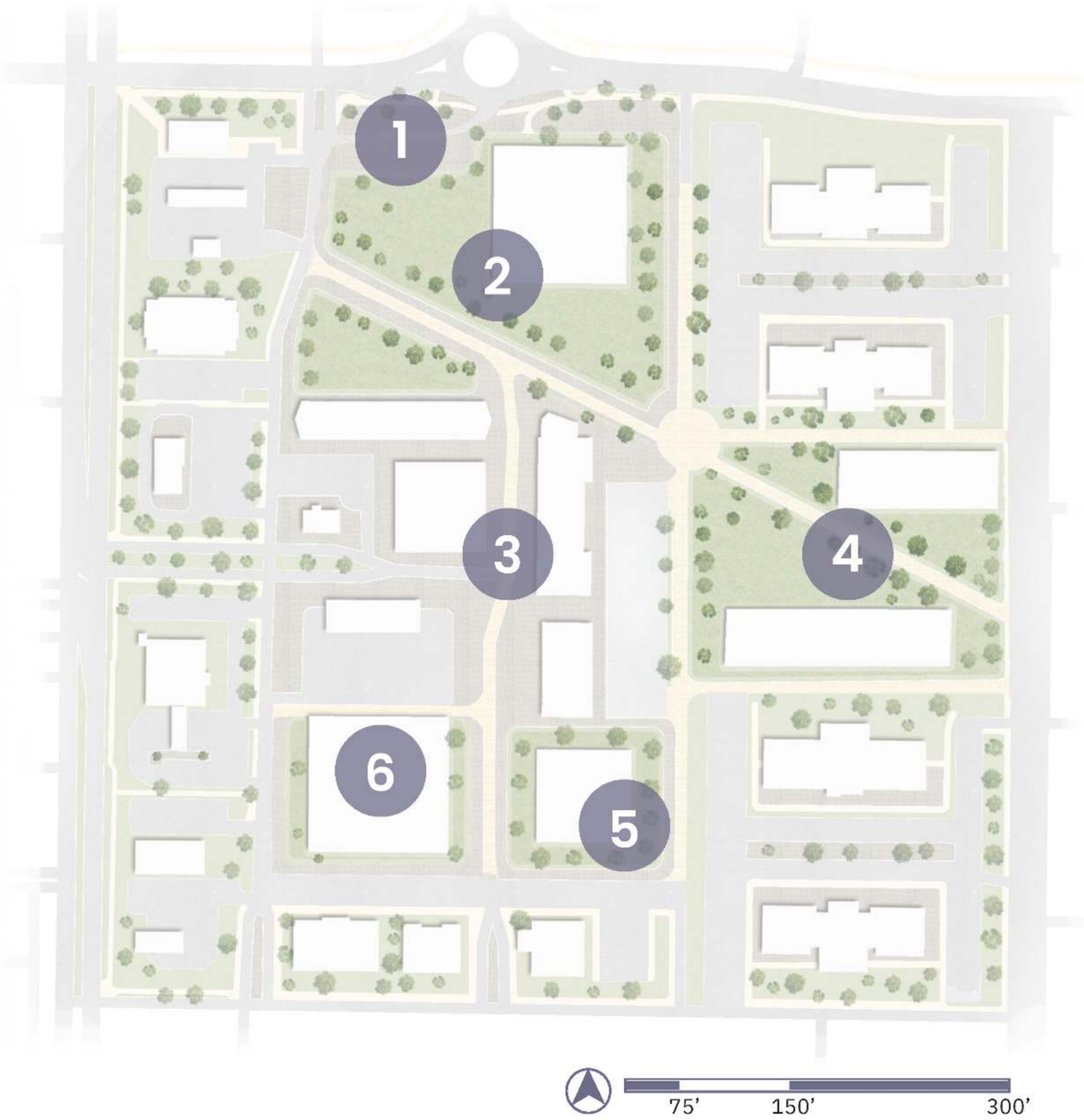
solar panels on all new and modified buildings, with some rooftops being activated for community use


Larimer and Weld Canal
287
Willox Ct
Aspen St
Cedar St
W Willox Ln
W Willox Ln
Green Leaf St
N Mason St
Westwood Dr
E Willox Ln
E Willox Ln
E Willox Ln
E Willox Ln
Salud Family Health Center
Sundance Cir N
Sundance Cir N
Butch Cassidy Dr
Greenbriar Village
Fox Glove Ct
N College Ave
N College Ave
College Ave
N College Ave
N College Ave
Larimer County Health Department
Blue Spruce Dr
Redwood St
Bayberry Ct
Bristlecone Dr
Bristlecone Dr
Hibdon Ct
Hibdon Ct
4980 ft
4979 ft
Red Cedar Cir
Goose Hollow Natural Area
4972 ft
Brewer Dr

Site Plan

Site Plan Key

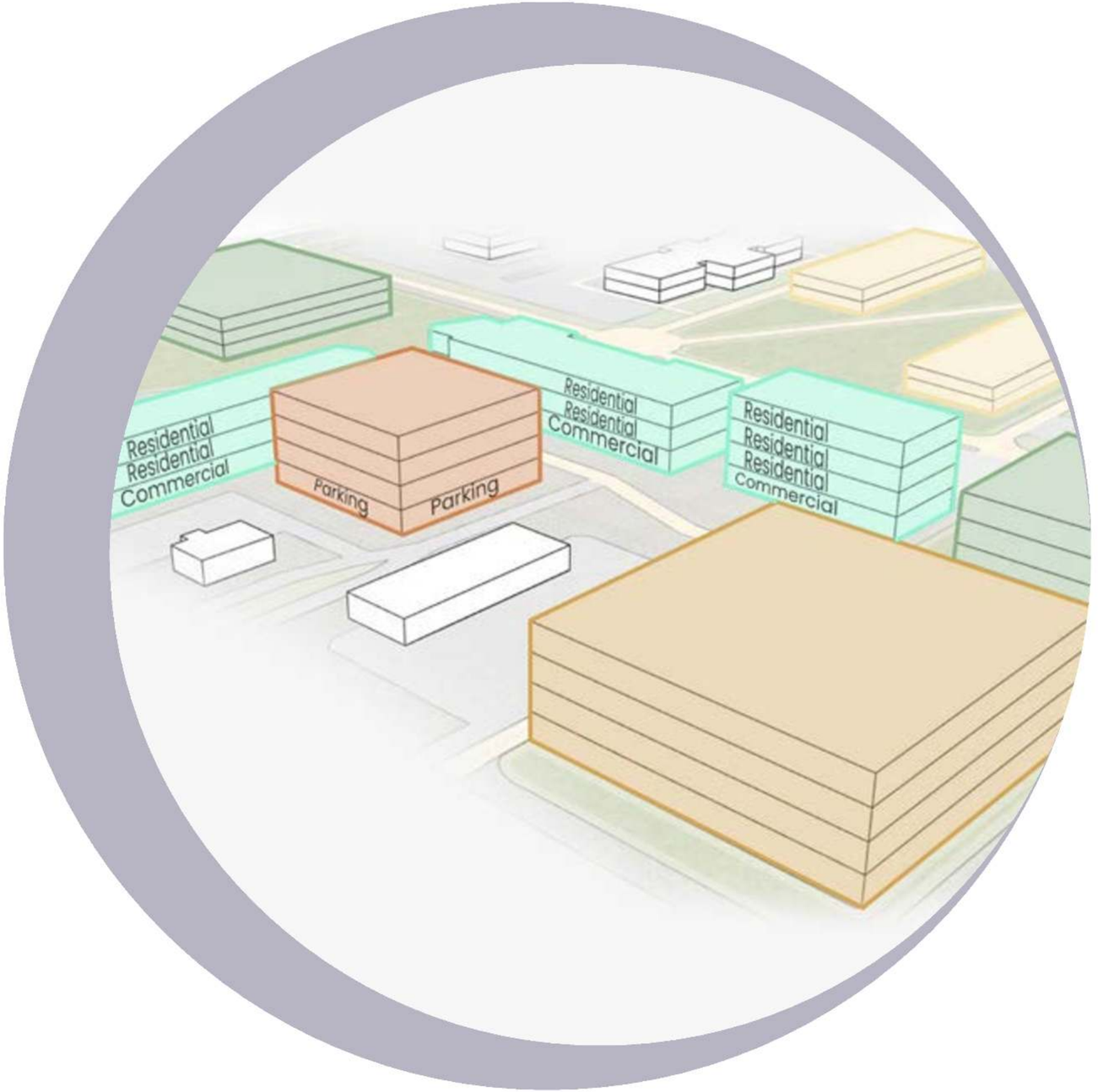
1. Transit Hub
2. Community Center
3. Mixed Use Main St .
4. Row Home Neighborhood
5. Cultural Event/ Market Space
6. High Rise Affordable Housing



Land Use

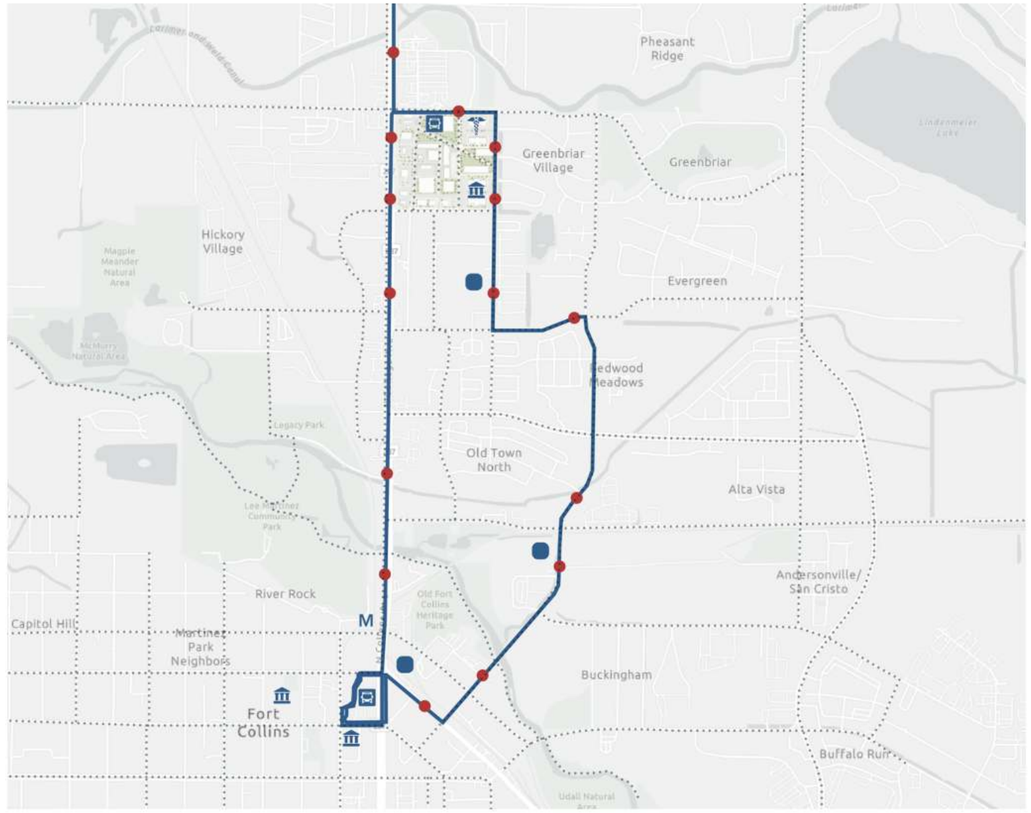


- Community & Culture
- Mixed Use
- High Density Residential/Parking
- Medium Density Residential
- High Density Residential



Site Circulation

Neighborhood Connection



- Bus Route
- Bus Stop
- Bike Connection
- Transit Center
- Health Services
- Gov't Services
- $ Shopping
- M Museum
- Other Landmark

Pedestrian Connectivity

The highlighted areas show any sidewalks, woonerfs, or shared streets that are safe and comfortable for pedestrians.

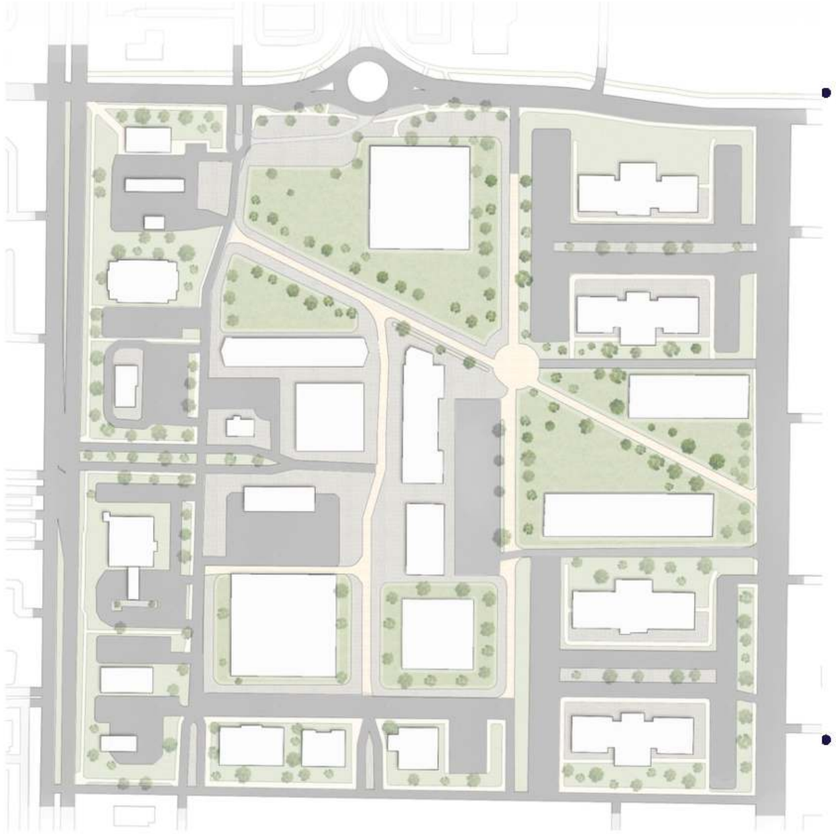


Bicycle Connectivity

The highlighted areas show shared streets, bike lanes(protected and separated), and woonerfs that allow cyclists to connect through the site.



Car Infrastructure



Automobile Connectivity

Car access within the site is reduced to access, instead of through-traffic. The center is kept car-free, only allowing for deliveries, emergency vehicles, or residents .

Parking

Aside from non-affiliated businesses, there is a greatly reduced amount of parking on site. The majority of this parking is for residents, and is not surface lot.

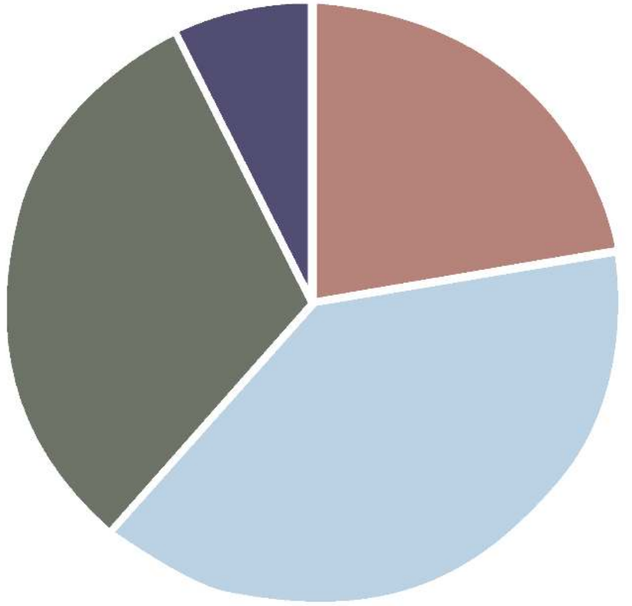


Housing



Housing

Housing options are in close proximity to shared semi-public, semi-private green spaces. The housing is in the center of the site, distanced from the noise & traffic of N College.



Unit Type Distribution

- 1 Bed
- 2 Bed
- 3 Bed
- 4 Bed

Landscape Design

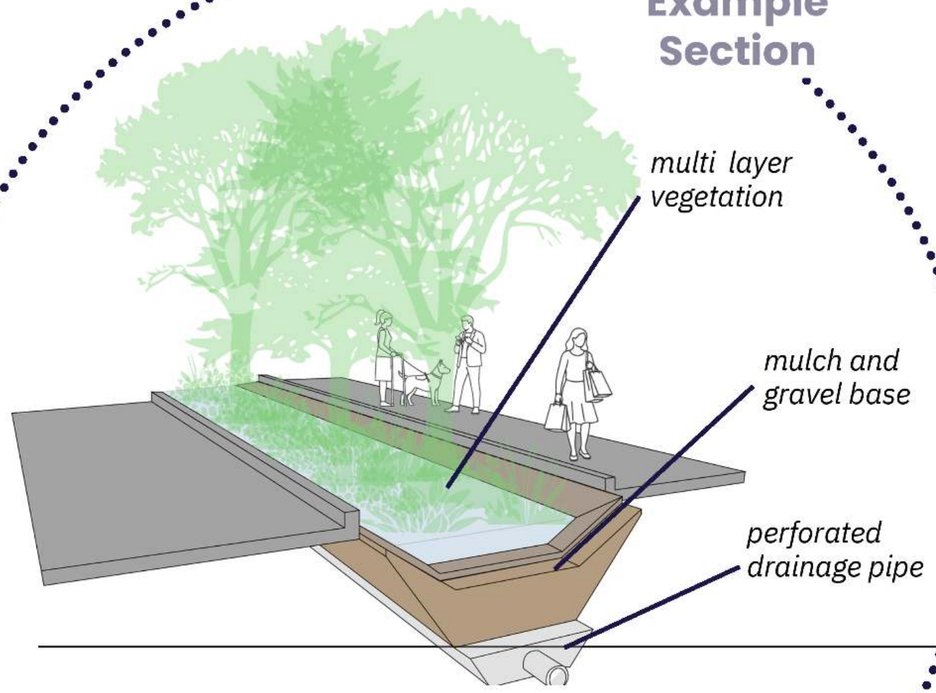
Planting Tool Kit

(some of the potential native plants that can be used on the site. more can be found on the city of FC website)



yarrow moonshine | *sage silver mound* | *big tooth maple* | *monkshood* | *white fir* | *hedge maple*

Example Section





Bioswales



Greenspaces

Urban Design Standards



before:



after:

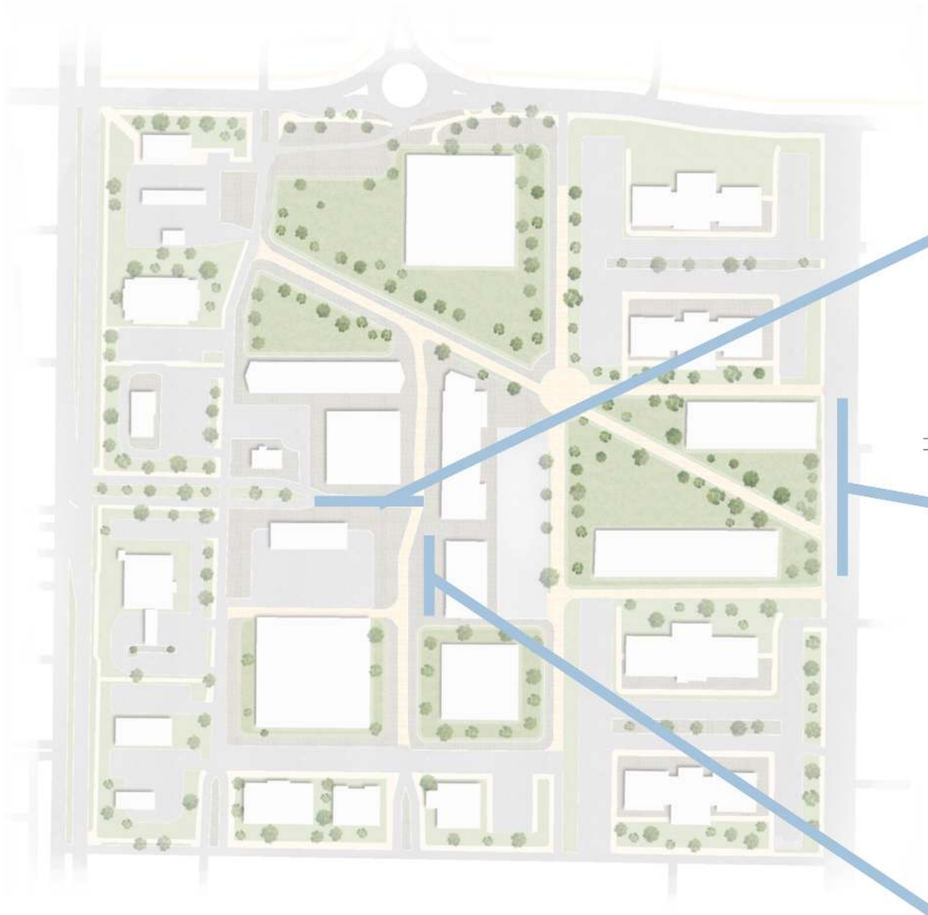


2 floors of added affordable housing

active frontage zones, existing businesses retain storefronts, & human scale

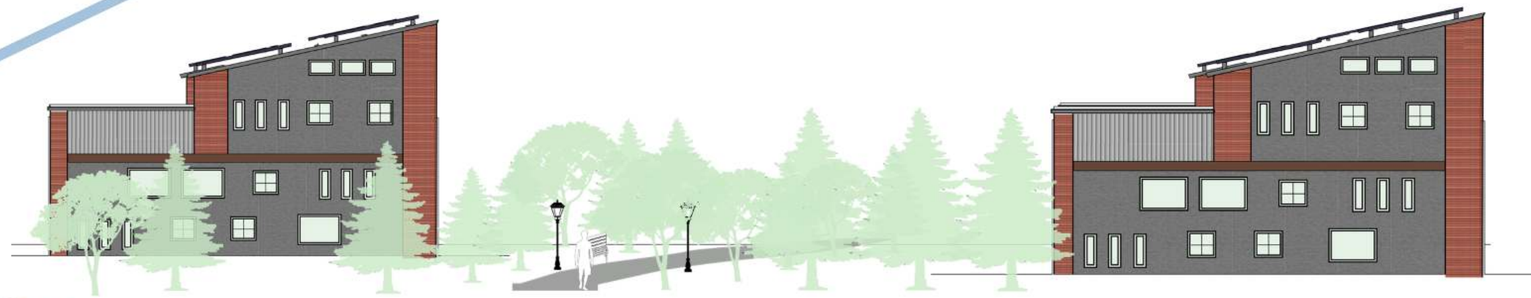
street furniture adds safety, comfort, & engagement

Housing Elevations





Apartments



Townhomes



Mixed Use

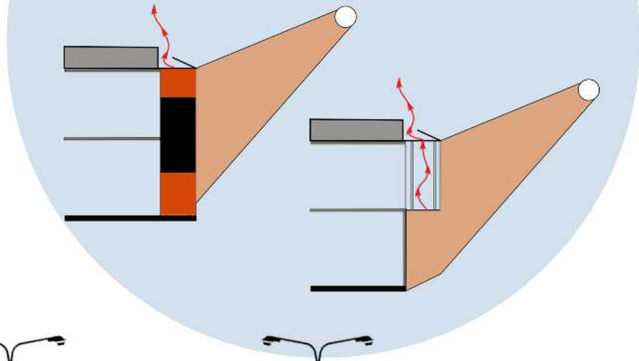
Community Elevations





Recreation Center

Double Skin Facade - consists of two layers of glass and a hollow interior which air flows through. This provides insulation from extreme conditions and improves temperature efficiency.





Cultural Event Space

Street Sections

Complete Street

Shared Street

Woonerf





Shared Street



Complete Street



Woonerf Alleys

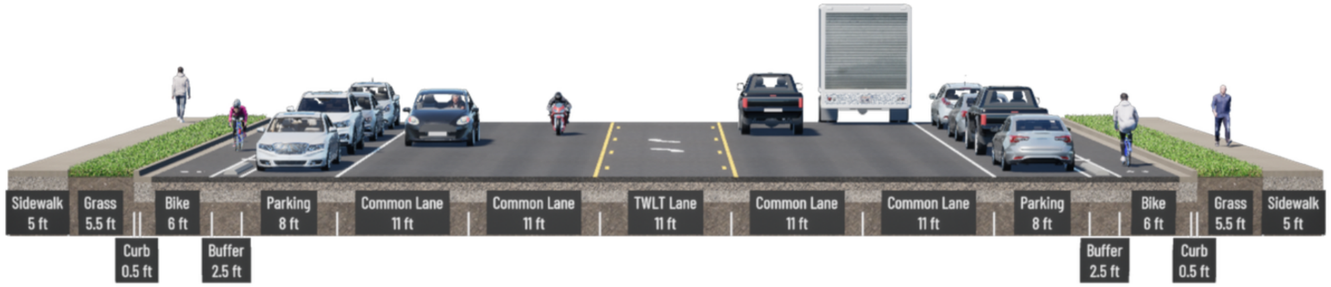
Street Section: **N College Ave**



before:



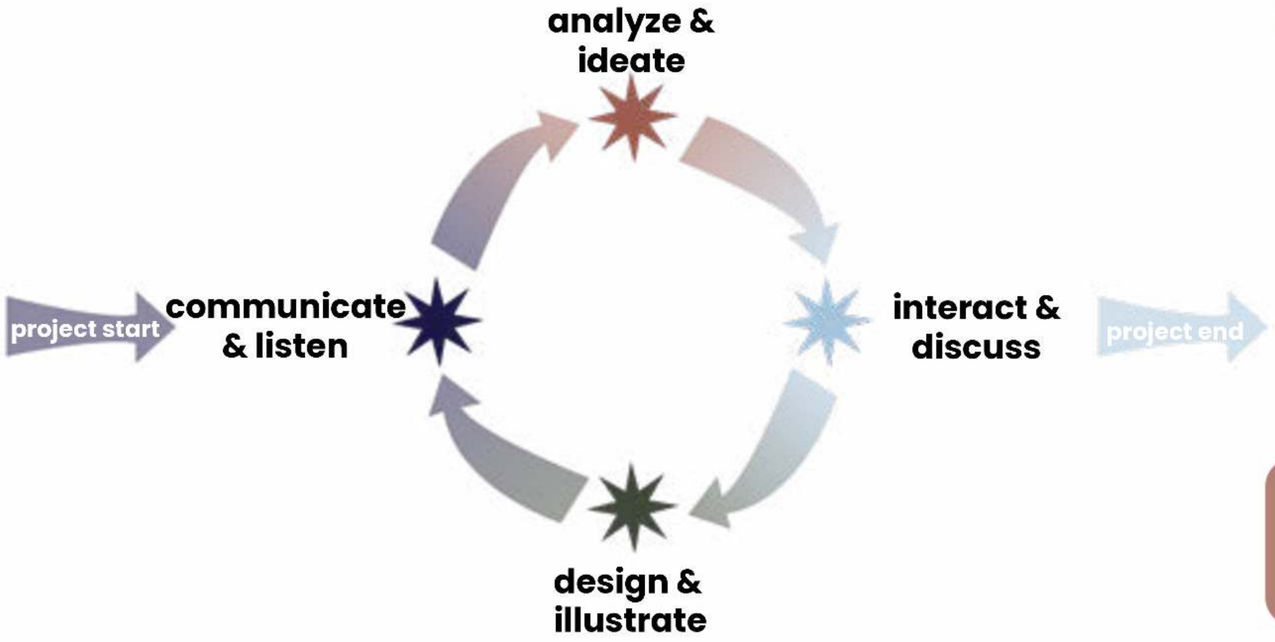
after:



Underpass



Community Integration



Design Charette



Allows community stakeholders to share their vision with designers

Walk & Talks



A format for conversational community engagement

Food Truck Festival



Use social events to reach out to the community and get feedback

Engagement Questions *(examples)*

- What type of bike lane would you feel most comfortable to riding in?
- What type of housing would you want to live in on this site?
- What would make you feel most at home/ welcome on this site?
- Would you feel safe crossing the street here to get to the community center?
- What services and activities would you want in a community center?
- Would you bike more if this infrastructure was available to you?

Creation of Sense of Place







- Bilingual Signage
- Locally Commissioned Murals, Art Installations
- Adaptable Programming - *allows users to define the space over time & with use.*



Phased Implementation

Months 0-12
POLICY, DESIGN, PREP

Years 1-2
INFRA. INSTALL

Years 2-3
CIVIC SPACE BUILD OUT

Years 3-5
MIXED-USE BUILD OUT

Years 5-6
FINAL ACTIVATION

0-12 Adopt zoning updates and finalize regulatory approvals to allow mixed-use, community-centered development. Complete environmental remediation.

1-2 Install core infrastructure, including utilities, stormwater systems, multimodal corridors, and early-phase public-realm elements.

2-3 Build the central civic plaza and key public spaces to establish an early community anchor.

Construct mixed-use and affordable housing buildings, prioritizing ground-floor local retail and services. Launch final buildout, tenanting, and community programming, ensuring long-term stewardship and activation.

3-5

5-6

Stakeholder Roles

Residents

Shape priorities through engagement and co-design. Act as project accountability anchors, ensuring fulfillment of goals.

City of Fort Collins

Zoning changes, approves site plans, coordinates public-realm investments, oversees transportation and utility upgrades.

Fort Collins URA

Primary financial catalyst. Facilitates land assembly, organizes community communication and design.

Community Organizations

e.g. La Familia: Provide cultural insight, guide bilingual design elements, inform public art and gathering spaces. Ensure programming reflects resident needs.

Design Teams

Lead the site design, building construction, infrastructure layout, and sustainability systems. Translate community priorities into built forms and coordinate with public entities.

Philanthropists

Support public art, youth programming, cultural events, plaza activation.

Transit Agencies

Implement BRT corridor improvements and circulation safety infrastructure.

State & Federal Agencies

Provide grant funding, tax credits, and regulatory oversight - for environmental remediation, affordable housing, and stormwater management.

Local Vendors/Businesses

Help activate the site with culturally relevant retail, food, and services. They partner on leasing frameworks and programming that keep the plaza lively and ensure economic benefits.



thank you